

French A1 — Week 7 Student Overview

Crescere | Beginner French | Week 7

Theme: Shopping, Clothing, and the Market

What You Will Learn This Week

Week 7 takes you into two of the most practical French shopping scenarios: a clothing shop and an outdoor market.

In Session 13, you will learn how to find, describe, and buy clothing. You will also learn demonstrative adjectives — *ce, cet, cette, ces* (this/that/these/those) — which you will use constantly in shops and everyday conversation.

In Session 14, you will learn how to shop at a French market: asking for quantities, specifying amounts, and checking prices.

You already know the ordering phrases from Week 6. Shopping follows the same logic — you know how to say what you want; this week you learn what to call what you want.

What You Will Be Able to Say by the End of Week 7

In a clothing shop:

Bonjour. Je cherche un pantalon noir, taille M. ... Vous avez ce jean en bleu? ... Je peux l'essayer? ... C'est combien? ... Je vais le prendre, s'il vous plaît.

At a French market:

Bonjour! Je voudrais un kilo de tomates et une douzaine d'œufs. Et donnez-moi 200 grammes de fromage, s'il vous plaît. C'est combien au total? ... Merci, au revoir!

Describing what you or someone else is wearing:

Je porte une chemise blanche et un pantalon gris. Ma collègue porte une robe verte et des chaussures noires.

Demonstrative Adjectives: Ce, Cet, Cette, Ces

To point to a specific item in French, use a demonstrative adjective. These agree with the noun:

Gender/Number	Form	Example	English
Masculine, before consonant	ce	ce manteau	this/that coat
Masculine, before vowel or h muet	cet	cet imperméable	this/that raincoat
Feminine	cette	cette robe	this/that dress
Plural (any gender)	ces	ces chaussures	these/those shoes

One form, two meanings: *ce/cet/cette/ces* cover both "this" and "that" in French. Context makes it clear which you mean.

The *cet* rule: Before a masculine noun starting with a vowel (or a silent *h*), you use *cet* instead of *ce*. This is purely for pronunciation — *ce imperméable* is hard to say; *cet imperméable* flows naturally.

Color Adjective Agreement

Colors in French come after the noun and agree in gender and number:

Color	Masculine sing.	Feminine sing.	Plural
black	noir	noire	noirs / noires
white	blanc	blanche	blancs / blanches
grey	gris	grise	gris / grises
blue	bleu	bleue	bleus / bleues
green	vert	verte	verts / vertes
purple	violet	violette	violets / violettes

Invariable colors — never change:

- *marron, orange, rose, beige* — same form always: *des chaussures marron, une robe rose*
-

Quantities at the Market

After any quantity word, French drops the article and uses just *de* (or *d'* before a vowel):

- *un kilo **de** tomates* (not *des tomates*)
- *une bouteille **de** vin*
- **une douzaine *d'*œufs*
- *500 grammes **de** fromage*

This is the same rule as after negation (*pas de*) — whenever you specify an amount, French uses bare *de*.

What to Practice Between Sessions

After Session 13 — before Session 14:

1. **Learn 5 clothing items.** Say each one with its gender: *un pantalon, une robe, un pull, une veste, des chaussures*. Say them with a color: *un pantalon noir, une robe verte*.
2. **Practice the shopping phrases.** Say "*Je cherche un pull bleu marine, taille M*" out loud. Then try the try-on request: "*Je peux l'essayer?*"
3. **Third try: no notes** on the shopping phrases.

After Session 14 — before Session 15:

1. **Say a market order out loud.** Invent a shopping list of 4 items. Say the full order with quantities: "*Un kilo de tomates, s'il vous plaît. Et une bouteille de vin rouge.*"
2. **Practice the price question.** "*C'est combien?*" — say it 10 times. It should be automatic.

3. **Review demonstratives.** Can you say the right form (*ce / cet / cette / ces*) for any noun without thinking?
-

A Note on Mistakes This Week

Two errors are very common this week:

1. **Using *ce* before a masculine noun starting with a vowel.** You will say "*ce imperméable*" — it should be "*cet imperméable*." Your instructor will correct it. After a few corrections, the pattern becomes automatic.
2. **Keeping the article after quantity words.** "*Un kilo du fromage*" → should be "*un kilo de fromage*." The rule is the same as after negation — when you specify an amount, just use *de*.

Neither of these will prevent communication. They are correction targets, not reasons to hesitate.

Crescere — French A1 Week 7 | Questions? Contact your instructor.